

long distance runners (marathons and beyond) start practicing? They start by running just a block or two every day. They do not even start by running or even jogging, they just walk fast. It is so very different from a 100 m or a 200 m sprint.

What smart long distance runners do not do is to go out and start running 20 kms on Day 1. They gradually build up to it. Learning to save is a lot like this marathon race. Start slowly and keep it simple. Do not get overawed by huge goals and the millions you need for financial independence. It will come as per the plan. Instead of continuing to focus on your end goal, focus on the daily habits that will take you to the end goal.

Since it is easy to forget some of these principles like patience in your daily grind, it is worthwhile to give this section a once-over every 6 months or whenever you feel you are disappointed. A single line, a single word, can just keep you hanging there instead of quitting. The storm will pass by. Just hang on. Give it time. Trust yourself. Trust HIM. Trust your plan.

Sharpen your financial saw

Bruce Barton once said: "Sometimes when I consider what tremendous consequences come from little things.... I am tempted to think that there are actually no little things."

Here's an example from the famous book *Seven Habits of Highly Effective People* by Stephen R. Covey.

Suppose you were to come upon someone in the woods working feverishly to saw down a tree.

"What are you doing?" you ask.

"Can't you see?" comes the impatient reply. "I'm sawing down this tree."

"You look exhausted!" you exclaim. "How long have you been at it?"

"Overfive hours," he replies, "and I'm beat! This is hard work."